United States of America

Congressional Record

PROCEEDINGS AND DEBATES OF THE 119th CONGRESS, SECOND SESSION

Vol. 172 WASHINGTON, FRIDAY, JANUARY 16, 2026 No. 12

House of Representatives

The House met at 3 p.m. and was called to order by the Speaker pro tempore (Mr. BEGICH).

DESIGNATION OF THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore laid before the House the following communication from the Speaker:

WASHINGTON, DC,
January 16, 2026.

I hereby appoint the Honorable NICHOLAS J. BEGICH, III, to act as Speaker pro tempore on this day.

MIKE JOHNSON,
Speaker of the House of Representatives.

PRAYER

The Chaplain, the Reverend Margaret Grun Kibben, offered the following prayer:

Merciful God, as we look back on the past week, we pray that You will be pleased with our efforts and would forgive our shortcomings.

Cause us to remember that when we have fulfilled Your purpose, readily received the opportunities You have laid before us, and completed Your work without hesitation, it was You who empowered us and You who should be praised.

Jars of clay that we are, we confess the times when we have dehumanized our enemies, when we have been slow to respond to the needs of others and quick to ensure our own comfort. Give us grace to approach You with humility and honesty.

Reveal to us that the treasure we steward is not our own well-being, but the bounty of Your gracious desire to transform all things, even us, so that Your surpassing power may be revealed in our lives and over all that seeks to distract and dissuade us from following You and living our lives in accordance with Your will.

We commend this past week and our work to Your care and Your blessing, praying in the power of Your merciful name.

Amen.

THE JOURNAL

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair has examined the Journal of the last day's proceedings and announces to the House the approval thereof.

Pursuant to clause 1 of rule I, the Journal of the last day's proceedings is approved.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair will lead the House in the Pledge of Allegiance.

The SPEAKER pro tempore led the Pledge of Allegiance as follows:

I pledge allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, and to the Republic for which it stands, one nation under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

COMMUNICATION FROM THE CLERK OF THE HOUSE

The SPEAKER pro tempore laid before the House the following communication from the Clerk of the House of Representatives:

OFFICE OF THE CLERK,
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES,
Washington, DC, January 15, 2026.

Hon. MIKE JOHNSON,
Speaker, House of Representatives,
Washington, DC.

DEAR MR. SPEAKER: Pursuant to the permission granted in Clause 2(h) of Rule II of the Rules of the U.S. House of Representatives, the Clerk received the following message from the Secretary of the Senate on January 15, 2026, at 5:27 p.m.:

That the Senate agrees to return the papers to the House at their request H.R. 1834.

That the Senate passed without amendment H.R. 6938.

With best wishes, I am,
Sincerely,

KEVIN F. MCCUMBER,
Clerk.

ADJOURNMENT

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Without objection, the House stands adjourned until noon on Tuesday, January 20, 2026, for morning-hour debate and 2 p.m. for legislative business.

There was no objection.

Thereupon (at 3 o'clock and 3 minutes p.m.), under its previous order, the House adjourned until Tuesday, January 20, 2026, at noon for morning-hour debate.

REPORTS OF COMMITTEES ON PUBLIC BILLS AND RESOLUTIONS

Under clause 2 of rule XIII, reports of committees were delivered to the Clerk for printing and reference to the proper calendar, as follows:

Mr. WALBERG: Committee on Education and Workforce. H.R. 1723. A bill to clarify the rights of Indians and Indian Tribes on Indian lands under the National Labor Relations Act, with an amendment (Rept. 119–458). Referred to the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union.

PUBLIC BILLS AND RESOLUTIONS

Under clause 2 of rule XII, public bills and resolutions of the following titles were introduced and severally referred, as follows:

By Mr. MEUSER:

H.R. 7127. A bill to amend the Securities Act of 1933 to exempt off-exchange secondary trading from State regulation where such trading is with respect to securities of an issuer that makes publicly available certain current information, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Mr. FLOOD (for himself and Mr. GARBARINO):

H.R. 7128. A bill to extend the Terrorism Risk Insurance Program, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Ms. BONAMICI (for herself and Mr. BEGICH):

H.R. 7129. A bill to amend the Energy Independence and Security Act of 2007 to reauthorize water power research, development, demonstration, and commercial application

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activities, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Science, Space, and Technology, and in addition to the Committee on Education and Workforce, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. DOWNING (for himself, Mr. FITZGERALD, and Mr. OGLES):

H.R. 7130. A bill to eliminate the Federal Insurance Office of the Department of the Treasury and to establish a United States Insurance Representative within the Department of the Treasury, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Mr. FITZGERALD:

H.R. 7131. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to eliminate the dollar limitations on the exclusion of gain from sales of principal residences, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Ways and Means.

By Mr. FOSTER (for himself, Mr. SHERMAN, Mrs. BEATTY, Mr. CASTEN, and Ms. VELÁZQUEZ):

H.R. 7132. A bill to amend the Financial Stability Act of 2010 to preserve the independent funding in the Office of Financial Research, to establish minimum staffing levels for the Financial Stability Oversight Council, to establish minimum funding levels for such staff, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Mr. FROST:

H.R. 7133. A bill to prohibit States from prohibiting or otherwise deterring the usage of any merchant category code established by the International Organization for Standardization, including codes that identify firearm merchants and ammunition merchants; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Mr. FROST:

H.R. 7134. A bill to amend title 18, United States Code, to improve firearm destruction practices, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. FROST:

H.R. 7135. A bill to improve the licensing requirements for the retail sale of firearms, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. HUDSON (for himself and Mr. HARRIGAN):

H.R. 7136. A bill to amend title 18, United States Code, to prohibit doxing of special operations personnel, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. JOHNSON of South Dakota (for himself, Mr. GOTTHEIMER, Mr. MACKENZIE, Ms. GOODLANDER, Mr. MANN, Mr. PANETTA, Mr. WITTMAN, Mr. CARBAJAL, Mr. STEIL, Mr. GOLDEN of Maine, Mr. FITZPATRICK, Mr. SOTO, Mr. BRESNAHAN, Mr. KRISHNAMOORTHI, Mr. GARBARINO, and Mr. DAVIS of North Carolina):

H.R. 7137. A bill to appropriate funds for pay and allowances of Federal employees, contract employees, and members of the Armed Forces during a lapse in appropriations, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Appropriations, and in addition to the Committees on Armed Services, Oversight and Government Reform, House Administration, and the Judiciary, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. KHANNA (for himself, Mrs. WATSON COLEMAN, Mr. DELUZIO, Mr. GARCÍA of Illinois, Mr. JACKSON of Illinois, Ms. SIMON, Mr. TAKANO, Mr. FROST, Ms. TLAIB, Ms. TOKUDA, Ms. LEE of Pennsylvania, Ms. KELLY of Illinois, Mrs. CHERFILUS-MCCORMICK, and Mr. THANEDAR):

H.R. 7138. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to disallow the deduction of certain expenses relating to ownership of single-family homes by specified large investors, to impose an excise tax on the sale of such homes by such investors, and to prohibit Federal mortgage assistance relating to certain large investors; to the Committee on Ways and Means, and in addition to the Committee on Financial Services, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. KILEY of California:

H.R. 7139. A bill to amend the United States Housing Act of 1937 to address the payment of tenant-based assistance in cases where a family moves, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Ms. LEE of Florida (for herself and Ms. LOFGREN):

H.R. 7140. A bill to protect main street retailers and end users in secondary patent actions, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mrs. MILLER-MEEKS:

H.R. 7141. A bill to amend title 38, United States Code, to modify the maximum guaranty amount of certain home loans guaranteed by the Department of Veterans Affairs; to the Committee on Veterans' Affairs.

By Mr. PANETTA (for himself and Mr. FEENSTRA):

H.R. 7142. A bill to amend the National Agricultural Research, Extension, and Teaching Policy Act of 1977 to extend and permanently authorize the Agriculture Advanced Research and Development Authority, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Agriculture.

By Mr. PANETTA (for himself, Mr. CARBAJAL, and Mr. MOORE of Utah):

H.R. 7143. A bill to amend title 23, United States Code, to improve and reauthorize the pollinator-friendly practices on roadside highways and rights-of-way program, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure.

By Mr. TORRES of New York:

H.R. 7144. A bill to amend the Emergency Food Assistance Act of 1983 to establish a national food rescue system through partnerships with food rescue organizations; to the Committee on Agriculture.

By Mrs. TRAHAN (for herself, Mr. VALADAO, Mr. CISCOMANI, Mr. CARTER of Louisiana, Mr. VEASEY, and Mr. SOTO):

H.R. 7145. A bill to amend title XIX of the Social Security Act to establish a definition of essential health system in statute and for other related purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Mr. WITTMAN (for himself, Mr. BERA, Mr. DAVIS of North Carolina, and Mr. MACKENZIE):

H.R. 7146. A bill to amend the Arms Export Control Act to include Taiwan among the list of recipient countries with respect to which shorter certification and reporting periods apply and to expedite licensing for allies transferring military equipment to Taiwan, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Foreign Affairs.

By Mr. STEIL (for himself and Mr. LYNCH):

H. Res. 1007. A resolution expressing the sense of the House of Representatives with respect to the use of artificial intelligence in the financial services and housing industries; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Ms. ANSARI (for herself, Ms. FOXX, Mr. HIMES, Mrs. BICE, Mr. SCHNEIDER, Mr. CAREY, Mr. SUOZZI, and Mr. FITZPATRICK):

H. Res. 1008. A resolution recognizing and expressing support for the Iranian people protesting for a free and democratic Iran; to the Committee on Foreign Affairs.

CONSTITUTIONAL AUTHORITY STATEMENT

Pursuant to clause 7 of rule XII of the Rules of the House of Representatives, the following statements are submitted regarding the specific powers granted to Congress in the Constitution to enact the accompanying bill or joint resolution.

By Mr. MEUSER:

H.R. 7127.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the United States Constitution.

By Mr. FLOOD:

H.R. 7128.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 18 of the United States Constitution

By Ms. BONAMICI:

H.R. 7129.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the U.S. Constitution

By Mr. DOWNING:

H.R. 7130.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8

By Mr. FITZGERALD:

H.R. 7131.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

clause 18 of section 8 of article I of the Constitution.

By Mr. FOSTER:

H.R. 7132.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

This bill is enacted pursuant to the power granted to Congress under Article I, Section 8, Clauses 1 and 18 of the United States Constitution.

By Mr. FROST:

H.R. 7133.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clauses 1 and 18 of the U.S. Constitution

By Mr. FROST:

H.R. 7134.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clauses 1 and 18 of the U.S. Constitution

By Mr. FROST:

H.R. 7135.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clauses 1 and 18 of the U.S. Constitution

By Mr. HUDSON:

H.R. 7136.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8

By Mr. JOHNSON of South Dakota:

H.R. 7137.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, section 8

By Mr. KHANNA:

H.R. 7138.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1 Section 8

By Mr. KILEY of California:

H.R. 7139.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section VIII, Clause XVIII

By Ms. LEE of Florida:

H.R. 7140.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8

By Mrs. MILLER-MEEKS:

H.R. 7141.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8 of the United States Constitution

By Mr. PANETTA:

H.R. 7142.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1 Section 8

By Mr. PANETTA:

H.R. 7143.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1 Section 8

By Mr. TORRES of New York:

H.R. 7144.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8.

By Mrs. TRAHAN:

H.R. 7145.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 18

By Mr. WITTMAN:

H.R. 7146.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the U.S. Constitution

ADDITIONAL SPONSORS

Under clause 7 of rule XII, sponsors were added to public bills and resolutions, as follows:

H.R. 220: Ms. MENG.
H.R. 429: Mr. THANEDAR.
H.R. 793: Mr. MFUME.
H.R. 1004: Ms. GOODLANDER.
H.R. 1061: Mr. POCAN and Ms. RANDALL.
H.R. 1065: Mr. CAREY.
H.R. 1267: Ms. STRICKLAND.
H.R. 1477: Mr. VEASEY, Ms. JOHNSON of Texas, and Mr. GOLDMAN of New York.
H.R. 1616: Mr. HIMES.
H.R. 1661: Ms. CASTOR of Florida.
H.R. 1745: Ms. GOODLANDER.
H.R. 1796: Mr. BISHOP.
H.R. 2021: Ms. CRAIG.
H.R. 2048: Mr. JOYCE of Ohio.
H.R. 2231: Mr. FRY.
H.R. 2232: Ms. LEE of Pennsylvania.
H.R. 2315: Mr. STEUBE.
H.R. 2385: Mr. VASQUEZ.
H.R. 2487: Mr. RASKIN.
H.R. 2512: Ms. SCHRIER.
H.R. 2627: Mr. VASQUEZ.
H.R. 2671: Ms. CROCKETT.
H.R. 2921: Ms. RANDALL.
H.R. 2940: Mr. CAREY.
H.R. 3172: Mrs. FOUSHEE.
H.R. 3497: Mr. MACKENZIE.
H.R. 3649: Ms. MCCOLLUM.
H.R. 3683: Mr. MOSKOWITZ and Mr. GOLDMAN of New York.
H.R. 3699: Mr. CLINE.
H.R. 3712: Ms. NORTON.
H.R. 3743: Mr. DAVID SCOTT of Georgia.
H.R. 4074: Mr. HIMES.
H.R. 4086: Mr. MACKENZIE.
H.R. 4206: Mr. CLYBURN.
H.R. 4294: Mr. GOSAR.
H.R. 4444: Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania.
H.R. 4469: Ms. TOKUDA.
H.R. 4568: Mr. VASQUEZ.
H.R. 4582: Ms. POU.
H.R. 4583: Ms. POU.
H.R. 4840: Mr. BARR.
H.R. 5017: Ms. PINGREE, Ms. MACE, Mr. FOSTER, and Mrs. LUNA.
H.R. 5171: Mr. SIMPSON.
H.R. 5461: Mr. FITZGERALD.
H.R. 5476: Ms. NORTON and Mrs. GRIJALVA.
H.R. 5582: Mr. FULCHER.
H.R. 5710: Mr. BABIN, Mr. SESSIONS, Mr. WILLIAMS of Texas, and Mr. BOST.
H.R. 5868: Mr. FITZPATRICK.
H.R. 5913: Mr. GOTTHEIMER.
H.R. 5973: Mr. TORRES of New York, Mr. LICCARDO, Mr. JACKSON of Illinois, and Mr. NEGUSE.
H.R. 6137: Ms. SCANLON and Mr. MACKENZIE.
H.R. 6191: Mrs. HARSHBARGER.
H.R. 6390: Ms. OMAR, Mr. GARAMENDI, and Ms. WILSON of Florida.
H.R. 6392: Mrs. HOUCHIN.
H.R. 6440: Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania.
H.R. 6469: Mr. SCOTT FRANKLIN of Florida and Mr. MULLIN.
H.R. 6491: Mr. STANTON.
H.R. 6643: Mr. ROSE.
H.R. 6659: Mr. WILLIAMS of Texas.
H.R. 6685: Mr. STEIL.
H.R. 6766: Mr. THOMPSON of California.
H.R. 6787: Mr. DOGGETT.
H.R. 6857: Mr. SMITH of New Jersey and Mr. PETERS.
H.R. 6875: Mr. MOYLAN, Mr. BAIRD, and Mr. FINE.
H.R. 6945: Mr. CLOUD.
H.R. 6997: Ms. ELFRETH.
H.R. 7016: Ms. GARCIA of Texas, Mr. MCGARVEY, Mr. THOMPSON of California, Mr. FOSTER, and Mr. LANDSMAN.
H.R. 7024: Mr. WIED and Mr. BISHOP.
H.R. 7025: Mr. LANDSMAN.
H.R. 7071: Mr. LARSON of Connecticut.
H.R. 7084: Mr. MCGUIRE.
H.R. 7088: Ms. ELFRETH, Ms. TITUS, and Mr. FOSTER.
H.R. 7100: Mr. SUOZZI, Mr. LAWLER, Mr. THOMPSON of California, Ms. LOFGREN, Mrs. MCIVER, Mr. COSTA, Mr. SHERMAN, Ms. TLAIB, and Mr. NORCROSS.
H.R. 7110: Mr. GARCÍA of Illinois.
H.R. 7112: Mr. HUNT.
H.R. 7115: Mr. CISCOMANI and Mr. OWENS.
H.R. 7119: Mrs. GRIJALVA and Mr. WALKINSHAW.
H. Con. Res. 68: Ms. BUDZINSKI, Mr. THANEDAR, Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania, Mr. OLSZEWSKI, Mr. BEYER, Mr. GARCÍA of Illinois, Mr. CASTEN, Ms. ELFRETH, and Ms. JOHNSON of Texas.
H. Res. 166: Mr. TAYLOR.
H. Res. 535: Mr. SMITH of Missouri.
H. Res. 993: Mr. ROGERS of Alabama, Ms. SALAZAR, Mr. STANTON, Mr. SHERMAN, Mr. LICCARDO, Mr. BILIRAKIS, Ms. PETTERSEN, and Mr. LANDSMAN.
H. Res. 996: Ms. CHU, Mr. GARCÍA of Illinois, Ms. BARRAGÁN, Mrs. GRIJALVA, Mr. SUBRAMANYAM, Ms. WATERS, Mr. DELUZIO, Ms. GARCIA of Texas, Mr. CASTRO of Texas, Mr. NADLER, and Mr. GARAMENDI.
H. Res. 1004: Mr. MFUME, Mrs. CHERFILUS-MCCORMICK, Mrs. MCIVER, and Ms. ADAMS.

DISCHARGE PETITIONS—ADDITIONS AND WITHDRAWALS

The following Members added their names to the following discharge petition:

Petition 11 by Mrs. LUNA on House Resolution 725: Mr. Courtney, Ms. Johnson of Texas, and Mr. Olszewski.

United States of America

Congressional Record

PROCEEDINGS AND DEBATES OF THE 119th CONGRESS, SECOND SESSION

Vol. 172 WASHINGTON, FRIDAY, JANUARY 16, 2026 *No. 12*

Senate

(Legislative day of Thursday, January 15, 2026)

The Senate met at 8:31 and 21 seconds a.m., on the expiration of the recess, and was called to order by the Honorable SHELLEY MOORE CAPITO, a Senator from the State of West Virginia.

APPOINTMENT OF ACTING PRESIDENT PRO TEMPORE

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will please read a communication to the Senate from the President pro tempore (Mr. GRASSLEY).

The bill clerk read the following letter:

U.S. SENATE,
PRESIDENT PRO TEMPORE,
Washington, DC, January 16, 2026.

To the Senate:

Under the provisions of rule I, paragraph 3, of the Standing Rules of the Senate, I hereby appoint the Honorable SHELLEY MOORE CAPITO, a Senator from the State of West Virginia, to perform the duties of the Chair.

CHUCK GRASSLEY,
President pro tempore.

Mrs. CAPITO thereupon assumed the Chair as Acting President pro tempore.

RECESS UNTIL TUESDAY, JANUARY 20, 2026, AT 10 A.M.

The ACTING PRESIDENT pro tempore. Under the previous order, the Senate stands in recess until 10 a.m. on Tuesday, January 20, 2026.

Thereupon, the Senate, at 8:31 and 51 seconds a.m., recessed until Tuesday, January 20, 2026, at 10 a.m.

● This "bullet" symbol identifies statements or insertions which are not spoken by a Member of the Senate on the floor.

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EXTENSIONS OF REMARKS

HONORING MAJOR MATTHEW N. TOPITZER

HON. JOHN R. CARTER

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. CARTER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I proudly salute Major Matthew N. Topitzer for his outstanding service to the United States Army and for the remarkable professionalism he has demonstrated throughout his military career. Major Topitzer has consistently embodied the dedication, integrity, and commitment to excellence that define the finest officers in our Armed Forces.

Major Topitzer's military journey reflects broad operational experience and steadfast leadership. He began his service as a Signal Platoon Leader in the 2nd Combat Aviation Brigade at Camp Humphreys, South Korea, and later led paratroopers in the 112th Signal Battalion at Fort Bragg. His expertise in communications and network operations took him to Special Operations Command—Europe in Stuttgart, Germany, and to Fort Belvoir, where he served as a technical project's leader for the 1st Capabilities Integration Group. In 2020, he deployed to Kabul, Afghanistan, serving as Deputy CJ6 for NATO Special Operations Joint Task Force—Afghanistan.

I had the privilege of working closely with Major Topitzer when he served as my Defense Fellow through the Army Congressional Fellowship Program. His thoughtful counsel, analytical rigor, and deep understanding of defense policy were invaluable to my office. Following his fellowship, he continued his exemplary service as a Congressional Budget Liaison to the Assistant Secretary of the Army for Financial Management and Comptroller, presenting key research, development, and intelligence portfolios before Congress.

Major Topitzer's achievements also include earning a Master of Legislative Affairs from George Washington University and completing advanced military education, including SERE High-Risk, Airborne School, and the Interagency Communications Course. He further demonstrates his commitment to service through his role as a White House Military Social Aide.

It is an honor to commend Major Topitzer for his distinguished service to the Army and the Nation. I extend my warmest congratulations to Matthew and his wife Ana as they continue this journey of service together.

HONORING CAPTAIN ISAAC CAMACHO

HON. TONY GONZALES

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. TONY GONZALES of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to pay tribute to Captain Isaac Camacho, a true American hero whose courage continues to inspire generations. Born on June 3, 1937, in Fabens, Texas, he moved to El Paso at the age of 13 after the passing of his father. He graduated from Jefferson High School in 1955 and immediately enlisted in the United States Army, joining the Airborne Infantry of the 11th Airborne Division. His dedication and skill led him to the elite ranks of the U.S. Army Special Forces, serving with the 1st Special Forces Group.

Mr. Speaker, Captain Camacho's service is marked by one of the most extraordinary stories of the Vietnam War. On November 22, 1963, during his second tour, he and three fellow soldiers were captured by Viet Cong forces at Camp Hiep Hoa. He endured more than 20 months in captivity under brutal conditions. Yet, his determination to return home never faltered. On July 9, 1965, during a heavy monsoon, he escaped by slipping through the bars of his cage and evading his captors for four days until encountering U.S. forces. He became the first American service member to escape from a Viet Cong POW camp.

His return home brought nationwide celebration. President Lyndon B. Johnson, Congressman Richard White, and El Paso Mayor Judson Williams personally honored him. But the most heartfelt recognition came from his mother, who had prayed for her son's return throughout his long captivity.

Captain Camacho's military awards reflect his extraordinary valor: the Distinguished Service Cross, two Silver Stars, two Purple Hearts, the Bronze Star, the Prisoner of War Medal, and numerous commendations. He also earned the Combat Infantryman Badge, Master Parachutist Badge, and multiple foreign parachutist honors. In 2009, he was inducted as a Distinguished Member of the Special Forces Regiment.

After retiring from the Army, he continued serving his country through a successful career with the U.S. Postal Service.

Mr. Speaker, Captain Isaac Camacho's heroism, strength, and devotion to duty stand as an enduring example of American resilience.

HONORING CYNTHIA ANN RODRIGUES

HON. WILLIAM R. KEATING

OF MASSACHUSETTS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. KEATING. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in honor of the life of Cynthia Ann Rodrigues of Westport, Massachusetts.

Born to parents, Joseph and Laurine Botelho, Cynthia was raised in Fall River, Massachusetts, where she gained a passion for protecting workers' rights from a young age. At 16, Cynthia began working in the garment industry as a machine operator and became an active organizer with her union, the Amalgamated Clothing and Textile Workers Union, which eventually became UNITE–HERE, AFL–CIO.

Cynthia's people skills and competence helped her to efficiently resolve disagreements on the shop floor, which quickly gained her recognition among her colleagues. Over the years, she continued to move through the ranks of the union, starting as a steward and eventually becoming a business agent, notably one of the first female business agents on the New England Joint Board. Throughout her decades with UNITE–HERE, AFL–CIO, Cynthia established English classes in union shops across New England and was responsible for managing and overseeing the collective bargaining agreements of over 1,500 members across the New England region. After working as a business agent for 22 years, Cynthia retired from UNITE–HERE, AFL–CIO in 2005, but she never fully retired from her work as a labor activist and organizer.

For 30 years, Cynthia served as the President of the Greater Southeastern Massachusetts Labor Council and was elected Secretary-Treasurer of the New Bedford/Cape Cod Labor Council prior to her role as president. Additionally, she was Vice President of the Massachusetts AFL–CIO, representing Southeastern Massachusetts until 2017, and served on the Steering Committee and Advisory Board of the University of Massachusetts Dartmouth Labor Education Center.

Sadly, we lost Cynthia too soon at the age of 81 on January 1, 2026. In addition to her impactful work as a union organizer, Cynthia enjoyed spending time with her friends and loved ones, camping, playing Bingo, and supporting the Wish Come True organization and was the beloved wife of the late John Rodrigues.

Mr. Speaker, I am proud to honor Cynthia Rodrigues, and I ask that my colleagues join me in recognizing her commitment to supporting and advancing workers' rights and bettering the lives of those around her.

HONORING THE SERVICE OF TIM MIKESKA

HON. JOHN R. CARTER

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. CARTER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I commend Tim Mikeska for being named Taylor's Outstanding Citizen. This well-deserved honor recognizes a lifetime of tireless service and outstanding contributions to the City of Taylor and the Central Texas community.

Tim's commitment to public service is reflected in his leadership on the Taylor City Council, the Williamson County Health District Board, the Taylor Economic Development Corporation, and the Greater Taylor Chamber of Commerce. His efforts have helped build a stronger, more resilient community where families and businesses can flourish.

As CEO of Mikeska's Bar-B-Q Inc., Tim has carried on a proud family tradition bringing the bold flavors of Texas barbecue to tables across the country, and even internationally to Germany, Bosnia and Herzegovina, and the United Kingdom. His work has earned national recognition through features on Food Nation on the Food Network, The CBS Early Show, and the Travel Channel.

Beyond the restaurant, Tim is a licensed EMT-Paramedic, instructor, and adjunct professor in Emergency Medical Services. In 1982, he founded the Taylor Heartsaver program, which has taught CPR to over 400 residents of east Williamson County, He also serves as a Command Pilot with Angel Flight South Central, Air Care Alliance, and Pilots N Paws, where he volunteers his time and aircraft to transport patients and animals in need of medical care.

Tim Mikeska's legacy speaks to the highest values we Texans hold dear. Through financial contributions, spiritual guidance, and feeding those in need, Tim's legacy will be felt for generations. I join the City of Taylor, his family, and all of Central Texas in congratulating him on this well-deserved honor. I thank him for a lifetime of service and wish him continued success and blessings in the years to come.

HONORING THE PASSING OF ROBERT ''GIBBY'' GIBSON

HON. THOMAS H. KEAN, JR.

OF NEW JERSEY

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. KEAN. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize the passing of Robert ''Gibby'' Gibson, a World War II veteran, and lifelong native of Hampton, New Jersey.

Mr. Gibson was drafted into the United States Army in 1943. There he trained as an anti-aircraft artilleryman. Mr. Gibson bravely landed in the second wave at Utah Beach during the historic ''D-Day'' invasion. Following this Mr. Gibson served through Normandy, the Battle of the Bulge, and continued his service into Germany until the end of the war. When Mr. Gibson returned home, he devoted his life to serving the people of Hampton, New Jersey. Mr. Gibson proudly served as a fire fighter, fire chief, councilman, and mayor, demonstrating his strong commitment to his community. As a humble and devoted man, Mr. Gibson, opened up and shared his wartime experiences with students and fellow citizens. He looked to educate others on his heroic experiences, using his personal journey to inspire future generations. Gibby passed away peacefully on January 12, 2026.

Mr. Speaker, as I recognize the passing of Robert ''Gibby'' Gibson, I am pleased to commend him for being an integral part of the Hampton area. I invite my colleagues to join me in honoring this heroic gentleman, truly dedicated to serving his country and community with courage, bravery, and commitment.

CELEBRATING 100 YEARS OF PETE'S ACE HARDWARE

HON. ERIC SWALWELL

OF CALIFORNIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. SWALWELL. Mr. Speaker, I rise to recognize Pete's Ace Hardware on the momentous occasion of its 100th anniversary, marking a century of service to the community of Castro Valley, California.

Founded in 1926 by Peter Selmeczki, Pete's Ace Hardware proudly holds the distinction of being the oldest business in Castro Valley. Peter and his wife, Mary, were hardworking Hungarian immigrants who built their livelihood through determination, resilience, and a deep commitment to their community. Together, they opened their store on historic Castro Valley Boulevard, where it remains a local landmark to this day.

In its early years, the business ambitiously offered both hardware supplies and automobile spray-painting services. While balancing these two ventures proved challenging, the Selmeczki family ultimately focused their full energy on the hardware business, laying the foundation for long-term success.

Initially serving local ranchers and farmers, the store evolved in tandem with the growing community. As Castro Valley expanded, so too did the business, adapting its inventory to meet the needs of contractors and homeowners. Throughout its growth, Pete's Ace Hardware remained deeply rooted in the community it served, thriving thanks to the loyalty of its customers and the support of trusted suppliers.

Pete and Mary's dedication to their business extended well beyond their lifetimes. Following their retirement and passing, their sons, Frank and Ernie, assumed leadership and guided the store through a period of growth and modernization.

Today, Pete's Ace Hardware is now a fourth-generation family-owned business led by Ernie's daughter Linda, her husband Jeff, and their son Jason.

As Pete's Ace Hardware celebrates this extraordinary milestone, I commend the Selmeczki family for their enduring commitment and entrepreneurial spirit. I extend my warmest congratulations to Linda, Jeff, and Jason as they continue to serve the Castro Valley community for generations to come.

SALUTING THE SERVICE AND SACRIFICE OF FIRST LIEUTENANT CHARLES W. ''WOODY'' McCOOK

HON. JOHN R. CARTER

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. CARTER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I salute the life and legacy of 1st Lieutenant Charles W. ''Woody'' McCook, a World War II hero and devoted patriot, who joined the angels in July of 1948. His courage, sacrifice, and unwavering sense of duty exemplify the very best of the American spirit. Though decades have passed since his final mission, his story continues to inspire all who cherish freedom and understand the cost of preserving it.

Affectionately known as ''Woody'' to his loved ones and fellow service members, Lt. McCook served as the pilot of a B–25C Mitchell aircraft during the Second World War. Answering his Nation's call, he bravely flew into the dangerous jungles of Japanese-occupied Burma, now known as Myanmar. His missions were perilous, often requiring low-altitude attacks and precise coordination in an environment where survival was never guaranteed.

For 82 years, Lt. McCook was listed as Missing in Action. Thanks to the tireless efforts of military recovery teams, his remains have finally returned home to Georgetown, Texas, where his family and community, after decades of unanswered questions, can now lay him to rest with the honor and dignity he earned.

Lt. McCook's service reminds us that freedom is not free. It is secured through the bravery of those willing to give everything in its defense. His return brings long-awaited closure to his family and a renewed appreciation from his country. As we mourn the passing of Lt. McCook, his presence was a blessing to all who knew him. The positive impact he had on the lives of others will live on and remain forever in our hearts.

HONORING THE LIFE AND LEGACY OF LAWRENCE JAMES JOHNSON

HON. SYLVIA R. GARCIA

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Ms. GARCIA of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor the life and legacy of Lawrence James Johnson of Houston, Texas, a devoted man of faith, a loving husband and father, and a tireless servant to his community.

Lawrence James Johnson was born on May 24, 1954, in Houston, Texas, to L.J. Johnson and Erma Lee Dixon Johnson. He attended schools in the Houston Independent School District, including 8th Avenue School, Hogg Middle School, Booker T. Washington High School, and Reagan High School. From an early age, Lawrence was shaped by a strong and prominent Christian family. He was baptized by his grandfather, Rev. C.D. Dixon, at Greater Mt. Pillow Missionary Baptist Church, and his faith remained a steady foundation throughout his life.

Lawrence's spiritual journey was marked by devotion and growth. Guided by the promise of Jeremiah 29:11, he rededicated his life to Christ and committed himself fully to living with purpose declaring, ''No turning back.'' He became not only a church member, but a faithful disciple, deepening his walk and dedicating himself to service.

At The Community of Faith Church, Lawrence was a constant presence and a reliable servant. He supported the church's growth and participated in major milestones over the years. He served wherever he was needed, embodying a spirit of responsibility, humility, and love for others.

On March 8, 1998, Lawrence was ordained as a Deacon at The Community of Faith by Bishop James Dixon II. He served with passion and compassion, including through the Overcomers Group and the Prison Ministry, sharing his personal testimony to uplift others and remind them that what we do in service to Christ is what endures.

Lawrence also exemplified integrity and commitment through his work. He served faithfully for more than a decade at Metro, and later took a leap of faith to build his own landscaping business. The Lawn Groomer—a reflection of his work ethic, entrepreneurial spirit, and determination.

In his personal life, Lawrence found the love of his life in Vickie Gloria Johnson, whom he married on November 25, 1995, at The Community of Faith Church. Together they built a life centered on faith, family, and service. Lawrence cherished every role he held—especially being ''Daddy,'' then ''Pawpaw,'' and ultimately ''Grand Pawpaw,'' embracing his family with deep joy and pride.

Lawrence and Vickie also served others with special dedication—especially homebound seniors, ensuring they received care, companionship, and support, including in the service of the Lord's Supper. He contributed to compassionate outreach efforts, helping deliver food to seniors through weekly community service initiatives.

On January 6, 2026, Lawrence James Johnson entered eternal rest. His life was defined by steadfast faith, devotion to family, and an unselfish commitment to others. He is preceded in death by his parents, L.J. Johnson and Erma Lee Dixon Johnson; his brother, Lloyd ''Poncho'' Johnson; his uncle, Pastor Robert Irving Dixon, Sr.; his aunt, Doris Cole; and his niece, London Lynette Kent. Lawrence is survived by his beloved wife, Vickie Gloria Johnson; his daughters, Katrina Carroll and Brandi Williams-Lee; his siblings, Jan Kent, Doris Allen, and Danny Johnson; his beloved uncle, James Dixon, Sr.; and countless extended family members, friends, neighbors, and members of his church family who were blessed by his unique spirit.

Mr. Speaker, the legacy Lawrence leaves behind is one of faith in action—service without recognition, love without condition, and perseverance through life's challenges. May we honor his memory by keeping Christ first, showing unselfish love to one another, and living by the words of his favorite scripture, Philippians 4:13: ''I can do all things through Christ, who strengthens me.''

I extend my deepest condolences to the Johnson family and all who loved Lawrence James Johnson. May his life continue to inspire all who were blessed to know him.

HONORING RAMON ''RAY'' A. BORREGO

HON. TONY GONZALES

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. TONY GONZALES of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor Ramon ''Ray'' A. Borrego, a proud American whose life of service reflects the highest traditions of our Armed Forces and our veteran community. At the age of 21, Ray Borrego was drafted into the United States Army in April of 1967. He completed basic training at Fort Bliss, followed by Advanced Individual Training at the renowned ''Tiger Land'' at Fort Polk, Louisiana, before deploying from Fort Lewis to Vietnam in September 1967.

During his year in Vietnam, he served with A Company, 2nd Battalion, 5th Cavalry, of the Airmobile Infantry Division, one of the most heavily engaged units of the war. After returning to the United States in 1968, he completed his service at Fort Dix and Fort Carson, receiving an Honorable Discharge in 1969.

Mr. Speaker, Ray's service did not end with his military career. His hometown of San Elizario has a long and proud military history, but for many years its veterans had only a small museum room honoring their contributions. In 2007, Ray helped change that. As a founding member and the very first Chairperson of the San Elizario Veterans Committee, he helped lead a remarkable transformation of how his community honors those who served.

Under his leadership, the Committee established a permanent Veterans Museum, created the Veterans Memorial Brick Walk, and expanded the annual Veterans Day Parade and Ceremony. The Committee also launched the Honor Salute for fallen San Eli veterans, supported cemetery upkeep, conducted fundraising, and championed the effort to designate San Elizario as a Purple Heart City. His leadership extended beyond San Elizario as a co-founder of the Lower Valley Veterans Alliance and a participant in Mission 15 of the Rio Grande Honor Flight.

Although Ray stepped down as Chairperson in 2024, he continues to serve as Co-Chair, demonstrating his ongoing commitment to honoring veterans across the Lower Valley.

Mr. Speaker, Ramon Borrego represents the best of our country—a soldier, a leader, and a dedicated servant to his community. Today we recognize and thank him for a lifetime of service.

CELEBRATING THE ROUND ROCK HIGH SCHOOL MARINE CORPS JROTC

HON. JOHN R. CARTER

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. CARTER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I am proud to recognize the Round Rock High School Marine Corps JROTC Academics Team, who achieved a historic first-place finish at the 2025 JROTC Leadership and Academic Bowl (JLAB) National Championship. This marks the first time a Marine Corps JROTC team has captured the overall national title across all service branches, and the first time a team from Round Rock has earned this distinction.

JLAB 2025 began in November 2024 with 3,543 JROTC programs from the Army, Navy, Air Force, Marine Corps, and Coast Guard. After months of rigorous online competition, only the top teams advanced to the national championship at Catholic University in Washington, D.C. Though Round Rock initially ranked ninth among Marine Corps programs, just outside the qualifying cutoff, an unexpected opening allowed them to compete. They went on to win the Marine Corps division and then defeat the champions from every other branch to claim the national title.

Their victory was the result of months of disciplined preparation, including weekly practices, competition simulations, and intense review of past contest materials. Under the leadership of retired Marine Master Gunnery Sergeant Olmeda, who served 23 years on active duty and is now in his eighth year teaching JROTC, cadets Niveda Swamynathan, Khushal Jalagam, Sylvia Marrone, and Ishaan Chokshi demonstrated exceptional dedication, teamwork, and academic excellence.

On behalf of the United States House of Representatives, I congratulate the Round Rock High School Marine Corps JROTC Academics Team, who have made Central Texas proud through their perseverance and groundbreaking achievement.

PERSONAL EXPLANATION

HON. HENRY C. ''HANK'' JOHNSON, JR.

OF GEORGIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. JOHNSON of Georgia. Mr. Speaker, during Roll Call Vote No. 28 on H.R. 7006, I mistakenly recorded my vote as YES when I should have voted NO.

RECOGNIZING THE 10TH ANNIVERSARY OF THE FIRST FAA-APPROVED DRONE DELIVERY IN THE UNITED STATES, COMMENDING LET'S FLY WISELY

HON. H. MORGAN GRIFFITH

OF VIRGINIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. GRIFFITH. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to commemorate a landmark moment in both American aviation history and rural health care innovation: the 10th anniversary of the first Federal Aviation Administration (FAA)-approved drone delivery, which took place in Wise County, Virginia, on July 17, 2015.

This groundbreaking event marked the first official drone package delivery in this country. It was the first time in our Nation's history that medical supplies were delivered to patients via Unmanned Aerial Vehicle (UAV), setting a global precedent for how drone technology can serve humanity.

The drone delivery was made possible through an extraordinary collaboration among several visionary partners:

Flirtey, a pioneering startup in commercial drone delivery (including co-founder and chief executive officer Matthew Sweeny; co-founder and chief operations officer Tom Bass; advisory board member Shyam Chidamber);

Health Wagon, a nonprofit health care organization that has served the medically underserved in Central Appalachia for over four decades (including chief executive officer, Dr. Teresa Gardner Tyson, DNP; clinical director, Dr. Paula Meade Collins, DNP);

Remote Area Medical (RAM), which organizes annual pop-up clinics providing free medical, dental, and vision care (including president, Stan Brock);

NASA Langley Research Center, which offered critical technical support and expertise (including director David E. Bowles; Frank Jones; John Foggia);

Mid-Atlantic Aviation Partnership (MAAP) at Virginia Tech, an official FAA-designated UAS test site (including director, Jon Greene; president, Timothy D. Sands);

Virginia Center for Innovative Technology, which facilitated public-private collaboration and integration;

Appalachian College of Pharmacy, which played a key role in preparing and ensuring the safe dispensing of the prescription medications delivered by drone (including adjunct associate professor of pharmacy, Dr. Shamly Abdelfattah); and

Jack Kennedy, Clerk of the Wise County Circuit Court, who was instrumental in pioneering and championing the concept of using drones for rural medical delivery in the Appalachian region.

Other Notable Partners: Shelcy Mullins, Sr. Fairgrounds; Lonesome Pine Airport manager, Jarrod Powers; RX Partnership executive director Amy Yarcich; Ryan Media Lab chief executive officer Mark A. Ryan and partner Kyle Mark Ryan; and Wise County UAS event coordinator, Andrianah Kilgore.

At that time, delivering medical supplies to rural sites like the RAM Wise County clinic event often required extensive hours of travel that could take hours or days of travel across rugged, mountainous terrain. But on that historic day, a drone carried the same supplies in just minutes—safely and efficiently delivering pharmaceuticals and medical supplies to patients.

This was more than a demonstration of technical prowess—it was a transformative moment for underserved communities. It showed how cutting-edge innovation could eliminate barriers to health care, reduce delays in treatment, and save lives in areas long overlooked by traditional infrastructure.

The implications extended far beyond Southwest Virginia. This mission laid the groundwork for nationwide drone delivery applications and inspired regulatory advancements by the FAA. It served as a springboard for companies to explore widespread drone delivery as a viable, scalable solution.

Mr. Speaker, as we reflect on the 10th anniversary of this historic achievement, we honor all those who made it possible. Their collective vision, determination, and compassion gave rise to a new frontier of health care access, born in the mountains of Central Appalachian Virginia but felt across the globe.

The first FAA-approved drone delivery was not merely a feat of aviation—it was a profound act of compassion. It marked a turning point in how we approach health care access for those living in rural communities. For areas long burdened by limited infrastructure and geographic barriers, this moment offered something far greater than innovation—it delivered dignity and hope. It was, in every sense, the ''Kitty Hawk moment'' for the drone delivery industry and the future of rural health care delivery.

RECOGNIZING MS. KIMBERLY DAY-SCANLON, OKALOOSA COUNTY SCHOOLS 2027 TEACHER OF THE YEAR

HON. JIMMY PATRONIS

OF FLORIDA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. PATRONIS. Mr. Speaker, I rise to recognize Ms. Kimberly Day-Scanlon as the Okaloosa County Teacher of the Year. For several years, Ms. Day-Scanlon has served Kenwood Elementary School with talent, passion, and an unwavering commitment to a quality education. In Northwest Florida, we are fortunate to have some of the best teachers in the Nation. It is recognized that the teaching profession is one of the most difficult yet rewarding professions in existence. Ms. Day-Scanlon has performed her teaching duties exceptionally, while also being an active and supportive member of her community.

Ms. Day-Scanlon's outreach extends far beyond the walls of her classroom through her active involvement in her school and community. Kimberly is currently a full-time teacher in Okaloosa County. She has taught students of all ages across various school settings for the last three decades. Kimberly also works with preservice teachers and as a mentor for new classroom teachers. She holds a BS in Special Education (College of Saint Rose) and a MS in Inclusive Education (Nazareth College). Kimberly is certified in Elementary Education, Exceptional Student Education (K–12), and is endorsed in Gifted, ESOL, Reading, and Autism Spectrum Disorders. For all of her admirable contributions to our community, I'm truly proud to have Ms. Day-Scanlon as a constituent in Florida's 1st Congressional District.

Mr. Speaker, on behalf of the United States Congress, I am privileged to recognize Ms. Kimberly Day-Scanlon for her many accomplishments, and her commitment to excellence, professionalism, innovation and collaboration in the Okaloosa County School District. I thank her for her service, and wish her all the best for her continued success.

CELEBRATING THE CAREER OF SUSAN KAMAS

HON. JOHN R. CARTER

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. CARTER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I proudly recognize Susan Kamas for her remarkable career and decades of service to the people of Central Texas. After fifty years in the workforce development field, including thirty-seven years leading Workforce Solutions of Central Texas, Susan retired in February 2025, leaving behind a legacy of visionary leadership and community impact.

Under her direction, Workforce Solutions of Central Texas became a statewide and national model for excellence in connecting job seekers, employers, and educators. Managing a $45 million annual budget, Susan built partnerships that strengthened the regional economy and expanded opportunities across Bell, Coryell, Hamilton, Lampasas, Milam, Mills, and San Saba counties. Her leadership also positioned the organization as a vital resource for veterans and military families in the Fort Hood (formerly Fort Cavazos) community.

Susan's influence extended well beyond Central Texas. She served as Co-Chair of the U.S. Department of Labor Enterprise Council, a founding member of the Coalition of State Workforce Associations, and an active member of organizations such as the Association of the United States Army and Rotary Club of Belton.

Her lifelong dedication has inspired initiatives such as the Susan Kamas Endowed Scholarship at Temple College, ensuring her legacy continues to benefit future generations.

On behalf of the United States House of Representatives, I thank Susan Kamas for her extraordinary leadership, commitment to service, and lasting contributions to the Central Texas community.

CELEBRATING CELESTE MADDEN'S 100TH BIRTHDAY

HON. WILLIAM R. KEATING

OF MASSACHUSETTS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. KEATING. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in honor of Celeste Madden as she celebrates her 100th birthday.

The daughter of Vincenzo and Elena Cicora, Celeste was raised in Brockton, Massachusetts, alongside her siblings Anthony and Anne. After graduating from Brockton High School in 1944, Celeste worked in a dress shop and as a teacher's aide, and a few years later married Timothy Madden. Together, they raised their four daughters, Elena, Marie, Teresa, and Cathy, and retired to Falmouth in 1986. Over the years, Celeste enjoyed gardening, doing yardwork, and travelling the country with her husband in their camper.

Today, Celeste enjoys doing crossword puzzles, reading, watching historical programs, for which she is grateful for the closed captioning on her tv, and spending time with her 9 grandchildren and 11 great-grandchildren. On January 17, 2026. Celeste will celebrate her 100th birthday.

Mr. Speaker, I am proud to honor Celeste Madden, and I ask that my colleagues join me in celebrating a century well lived and wishing Celeste many more years of health and happiness.

HONORING SHERRIF DARRIN MITCHELL

HON. TONY GONZALES

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. TONY GONZALES of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize a distinguished public servant, veteran, and law enforcement leader—Sheriff Darrin Mitchell—whose decades of service to our Nation and to the people of Texas exemplify duty, courage, and integrity.

Darrin Mitchell began his service to the United States in January of 1985 when he enlisted in the United States Army as a Parachute Rigger. His first assignment placed him among some of our Nation's most elite warriors, serving with the 5th Special Forces Group (Airborne). Initially stationed at Fort Bragg, North Carolina, he continued his service when the unit relocated to Fort Campbell, Kentucky. Mr. Speaker, during this period he supported critical missions and deployed in support of Operations Desert Shield and Desert Storm from 1990 to 1991—two of the most consequential military operations of the modern era. His work ensured that America's airborne forces remained supplied, prepared, and mission-ready in the harshest conditions.

After receiving an honorable separation from the Army in 1994, Darrin Mitchell continued his commitment to public service by pursuing a career in law enforcement. He attended and graduated from the Permian Basin Regional Police Academy in 1995 and that same year joined the Winkler County Sheriff's Office, where he served with dedication until 2002. His call to serve then brought him to the Department of Homeland Security's Transportation Security Administration. From 2002 to 2009, he served as a Master Behavioral Detection Officer—one of TSA's most specialized roles—helping safeguard the traveling public in the years following the 9/11 attacks.

In 2009, he returned to the Winkler County Sheriff's Office, first as a Correctional Officer, then as a Patrol Deputy in 2010. His leadership, professionalism, and investigative skill led to his promotion as Chief Investigator in 2012. When the sitting Sheriff retired in 2016, Darrin Mitchell stepped forward once again, running for office and earning the trust of the community he had served for so many years. He was elected Sheriff of Winkler County and has since continued to protect and lead with distinction.

Mr. Speaker, Sheriff Darrin Mitchell represents the highest ideals of service—first in uniform defending our Nation, and later in law enforcement safeguarding his community. Today, we honor his enduring commitment and his exemplary career of service to Texas and the United States.

HONORING THE MINISTRY OF PASTOR DAN WOOLDRIDGE

HON. JOHN R. CARTER

OF TEXAS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Friday, January 16, 2026

Mr. CARTER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor Pastor Dan Wooldridge as he retires after more than five decades of faithful ministry. Since 1972, Pastor Wooldridge has pastored churches across Texas, offering spiritual guidance, leadership, and unwavering dedication to his calling.

A graduate of Howard Payne University, Pastor Wooldridge has spent his life sharing his faith, not only in Central Texas, but around the world. His evangelism and missionary efforts have reached South America, Cuba, Romania, Southeast Asia, and the United Kingdom, reflecting a heart for service and a passion for spreading God's Word.

At Crestview Baptist Church in Georgetown, he helped expand the church's ministry through initiatives like Crestview Camp, local outreach, and strengthened partnerships with the Williamson Baptist Association. His impact extended beyond the church walls—serving on the Board of Partners for Education, driving school buses, and supporting student athletics. Pastor Wooldridge has lived out Christ's words: "Whatever you did for one of the least of these brothers and sisters of mine, you did for me."

He and his wife Shannon have raised three children, and together they have been a steadfast example of faith, family, and service to the community.

On behalf of the United States House of Representatives, I commend Pastor Dan Wooldridge for fifty-three years of remarkable ministry. His legacy is one of compassion, conviction, and commitment to others. I wish him and Shannon continued joy and purpose in the years ahead.

Daily Digest

Senate

Chamber Action

The Senate met at 8:31:21 a.m. in pro forma session, and recessed at 8:31:51 a.m. until 10 a.m. on Tuesday, January 20, 2026.

Committee Meetings

No committee meetings were held.

House of Representatives

Chamber Action

Public Bills and Resolutions Introduced: 20 public bills, H.R. 7127–7146; and 2 resolutions, H. Res. 1007–1008 were introduced. **Pages H923–24**

Additional Cosponsors: **Page H925**

Report Filed: A report was filed today as follows:

H.R. 1723, to clarify the rights of Indians and Indian Tribes on Indian lands under the National Labor Relations Act, with an amendment (H. Rept. 119–458). **Page H923**

Speaker: Read a letter from the Speaker wherein he appointed Representative Begich to act as Speaker pro tempore for today. **Page H923**

Senate Message: Message from the Senate received by the Clerk and subsequently presented to the House today appears on page H923.

Quorum Calls—Votes: There were no Yea and Nay votes, and there were no Recorded votes. There were no quorum calls.

Adjournment: The House met at 3 p.m. and adjourned at 3:03 p.m.

Committee meetings

No hearings were held.

Joint Meetings

No joint committee meetings were held.

COMMITTEE MEETINGS FOR TUESDAY, JANUARY 20, 2026

(Committee meetings are open unless otherwise indicated)

Senate

No meetings/hearings scheduled.

House

Committee on Rules, Full Committee, hearing on H.R. 6945, the ''Supporting Pregnant and Parenting Women and Families Act''; H.R. 6359, the ''Pregnant Students' Rights Act''; H.J. Res. 140, providing for congressional disapproval under chapter 8 of title 5, United States Code, of the rule submitted by the Bureau of Land Management relating to Public Land Order No. 7917 for Withdrawal of Federal Lands; Cook, Lake, and Saint Louis Counties, MN, 3 p.m., H–313 Capitol.

CONGRESSIONAL PROGRAM AHEAD

Week of January 19 through January 23, 2026

Senate Chamber

On *Tuesday*, Senate will meet in a pro forma session.

Senate Committees

(Committee meetings are open unless otherwise indicated)

No meetings/hearings scheduled.

House Committees

Committee on Education and Workforce, January 21, Full Committee, markup on H.R. 7082, the ''Fostering Learning and Excellence in Charter Schools (FLEX) Act''; H.R. 7086, the ''Equitable Access to School Facilities Act'';

and H.R. 4624, the ''Muhammad Ali American Boxing Revival Act'', 10:15 a.m., 2175 Rayburn.

January 22, Subcommittee on Workforce Protections, hearing entitled ''Examining the Policies and Priorities of the Mine Safety and Health Administration'', 10:15 a.m., 2175 Rayburn.

Committee on Energy and Commerce, January 21, Full Committee, markup on H.R. 6409, the ''Foreign Emissions and Nonattainment Clarification for Economic Stability''; H.R. 4218, the ''Clean Air and Economic Advancement Reform (CLEAR) Act''; H.R. 6387, the ''Fire Improvement and Reforming Exceptional Events (FIRE) Act''; H.R. 4214, the ''Clean Air and Building Infrastructure Improvement Act''; H.R. 161, the ''New Source Review Permitting Improvement Act''; H.R. 6373, the ''Air Permitting Improvements to Protect National Security Act''; H.R. 6398, the ''Reducing and Eliminating Duplicative Environmental Regulations (RED Tape) Act''; H.R. 2072, to require the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission to extend the time period during which licensees are required to commence construction of certain hydropower projects; H.R. 5200, the ''Emergency Reporting Act''; H.R. 5201, the ''Kari's Law Reporting Act''; and H.R. 2076, the ''LuLu's Law'', 10:15 a.m., 2123 Rayburn.

January 22, Subcommittee on Health, hearing entitled ''Lowering Health Care Costs for All Americans: An Examination of Health Insurance Affordability'', 9:45 a.m., 2123 Rayburn.

January 22, Subcommittee on Energy and Mineral Resources, hearing entitled ''Deep Dive: Examining the Regulatory and Statutory Barriers to Deep Sea Mining'', 2 p.m., 1334 Longworth.

January 22, Subcommittee on Environment, hearing entitled ''Chemicals in Commerce: Legislative Proposal to Modernize America's Chemical Safety Law, Strengthen Critical Supply Chains, and Grow Domestic Manufacturing'', 2 p.m., 2123 Rayburn.

Committee on Financial Services, January 21, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Oversight of the Department of Housing and Urban Development and the Federal Housing Administration'', 10 a.m., 2128 Rayburn.

Committee on Foreign Affairs, January 21, Full Committee, markup on H.R. 6875, to require the Under Secretary of Commerce for Industry and Security to require a license for the export, reexport, or in-country transfer of certain integrated circuits, and for other purposes; H.R. 6275, to require the Secretary of Commerce to submit a report annually on the advanced artificial intelligence capabilities of the People's Republic of China, and for other purposes; H.R. 5491, to encourage diplomatic advocacy efforts on behalf of Americans unjustly detained in the People's Republic of China; H.R. 7036, to increase collaboration within the Department of State between the Office of Opinion Research of the Bureau of Intelligence and Research and the Bureau of Global Public Affairs; H.R. 7028, to require the Secretary of State to submit a notification to Congress prior to obligating funds for certain art-related purchases, and for other purposes; H.R. 6411, to direct the Secretary of State to prepare a report on the treatment of ethnic minorities in Serbia; H.R. 7054, to require the Secretary of State to submit to Congress a notification of certain construction projects using nonstandard designs; H.R. 4532, to direct the Secretary of State to develop a strategy on efforts to strengthen subnational cooperation between the United States and Mexico, and for other purposes; H. Res. 515, commemorating the 90th birthday of His Holiness the Dalai Lama on July 6, 2025, as ''A Day of Compassion'', and expressing support for the human rights, religious freedom, and cultural and linguistic protection of the Tibetan people; H.R. 4368, to authorize the Caribbean Basin Security Initiative, to enhance the United States-Caribbean security partnership, to prioritize natural disaster resilience, and for other purposes; H.R. 3307, to increase cooperation with countries in the Eastern Mediterranean region in order to strengthen energy security and defense capabilities, and for other purposes; and H.R. 7052, to establish a Center for Conflict Analysis, Planning, and Prevention in the Department of State, and for other purposes, 10 a.m., 2172 Rayburn.

January 22, Africa Subcommittee, hearing entitled ''Advancing Peace in DRC and Rwanda through President Trump's Washington Accords'', 2 p.m., 2172 Rayburn.

Committee on Homeland Security, January 21, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Oversight of the Department of Homeland Security: CISA, TSA, S&T'', 10 a.m., 310 Cannon.

January 22, Subcommittee on Border Security and Enforcement, hearing entitled ''Smarter Borders, Safer Nation: Expanding the Use of Non-Intrusive Inspection Technology'', 10 a.m., 310 Cannon.

Committee on House Administration, January 22, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Oversight of the Government Publishing Office in a Digital-First Era'', 2 p.m., 1310 Longworth.

Committee on the Judiciary, January 21, Subcommittee on Crime and Federal Government Surveillance, hearing entitled ''When Public Funds Are Abused: Addressing Fraud and the Theft of Taxpayer Dollars'', 10 a.m., 2141 Rayburn.

January 21, Subcommittee on Oversight, hearing entitled ''Embedded Threats: Foreign Ownership, Hidden Hardware, and Licensing Failures in America's Transportation Systems'', 2 p.m., 2141 Rayburn.

January 22, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Oversight of the Office of Special Counsel Jack Smith'', 10 a.m., 2141 Rayburn.

Committee on Natural Resources, January 21, Subcommittee on Federal Lands, hearing entitled ''EXPLORE America250: Celebrating One Year of the Expanding Public Lands Outdoor Recreation Experiences Act'', 10:15 a.m., 1324 Longworth.

January 21, Subcommittee on Oversight and Investigations, hearing entitled ''America First: U.S. Leadership and National Security in International Conservation'', 2 p.m., 1324 Longworth.

January 22, Subcommittee on Energy and Mineral Resources, hearing entitled ''Deep Dive: Examining the Regulatory and Statutory Barriers to Deep Sea Mining'', 2 p.m., 1334 Longworth.

Committee on Oversight and Government Reform, January 21, Full Committee, markup on legislation on recommending that the House of Representatives find William J. Clinton in Contempt of Congress for refusal to comply with a subpoena duly issued by the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform; and legislation on recommending that the House of Representatives find Hillary R. Clinton in Contempt of Congress for refusal to comply with a subpoena duly issued by the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform, 10 a.m., HVC–210.

January 22, Task Force on the Declassification of Federal Secrets, hearing entitled ''Declassified MLK Records: What They Reveal and Why They Matter'', 10 a.m., HVC–210.

January 22, Subcommittee on Economic Growth, Energy Policy, and Regulatory Affairs, hearing entitled ''Housing Affordability: Saving the American Dream'', 2 p.m., 2247 Rayburn.

Committee on Science, Space, and Technology, January 22, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Assessing U.S. Leadership in Quantum Science and Technology'', 10 a.m., 2318 Rayburn.

Committee on Small Business, January 21, Subcommittee on Rural Development, Energy, and Supply Chains, hearing entitled ''Empowering Rural America Through Investment in Innovation'', 10 a.m., 2360 Rayburn.

January 22, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Local Ownership, National Brands: How Franchising is a Pathway to Entrepreneurship'', 2 p.m., 2360 Rayburn.

Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure, January 21, Full Committee, markup on H.R. 7084, the ''Defending American Property Abroad Act of 2026''; H.R. 6744, the ''Military Air Traffic Control Transition Act''; H.R. 6618, the ''Wildfire Aerial Response Safety Act''; H.R. 2247, the ''Pilot Certificate Accessibility Act''; and H.R. 2474, the ''Expanding Appalachia's Broadband Access Act'', 10 a.m., 2167 Rayburn.

January 22, Subcommittee on Economic Development, Public Buildings, and Emergency Management, hearing entitled ''Smarter Spending, Stronger Results: Reducing Duplication and Ensuring Effectiveness Through Economic Development Reforms'', 10 a.m., 2167 Rayburn.

Committee on Veterans' Affairs, January 21, Subcommittee on Economic Opportunity, hearing on H.R. 982, the ''Warriors to Workforce Act''; H.R. 2878, the ''Daniel J. Harvey, Jr. and Adam Lambert Improving Servicemember Transition to Reduce Veteran Suicide Act''; H.R. 4105, the ''VET Act of 2025''; H.R. 5634, the ''Veterans Flight Training Responsibility Act of 2025''; legislation on the CRUISE Act; legislation on the Improving Mental Health Care and Coordination for Homeless Veterans Act; legislation on the Improving Emerging Tech Opportunities for Veterans Act; legislation on the Affordable Housing Guarantee Act; H.R. 3159, the ''Improving SCRA Benefit Utilization Act''; H.R. 5436, to amend title 38, United States Code, to prohibit an educational institution from withholding a transcript from an individual who pursued a course or program of education at such institution using Post-9/11 educational assistance; legislation to amend title 38, United States Code, to require the Secretary of Veterans Affairs to submit to Congress a quarterly report on housing loans insured, guaranteed, or under laws administered by the Secretary, and for other purposes; and legislation on the Veteran Housing Promise Act, 2:30 p.m., 360 Cannon.

January 22, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Community Care Network Next Generation: One Trillion of Oversight'', 10:15 a.m., 360 Cannon.

Committee on Ways and Means, January 21, Subcommittee on Work and Welfare, hearing entitled ''Strengthening the Child Support Enforcement Program: Status, Challenges, and Opportunities for Modernization'', 3 p.m., 2020 Rayburn.

January 22, Full Committee, hearing entitled ''Hearing with Health Insurance CEOs'', 2:30 p.m., 1100 Longworth.

Permanent Select Committee on Intelligence, January 22, Subcommittee on Defense Intelligence and Overhead Architecture, hearing entitled ''Cover Enhancement Authorities'', 12 p.m., HVC–304 Hearing Room. This hearing is closed.

Next Meeting of the SENATE

10 a.m., Tuesday, January 20

Senate Chamber

Program for Tuesday: Senate will meet in a pro forma session.

Next Meeting of the HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

12 noon, Tuesday, January 20

House Chamber

Program for Tuesday: To be announced.

Extensions of Remarks, as inserted in this issue

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